From conversations to a next move

Instructor guide · 60 minutes

First Ten teaching kit 1.0 · October 18, 2026. Suitable for pairs or groups of three; individuals can use a self-check. No account, AI, paid service or outside contact is required. This is a fictional classroom exercise, followed by an optional one-week field assignment.

Prepare: give students paper or an accessible document. Keep the structured worksheets and model reasoning hidden until after their first thinking. At minute 10, show only the StudyLoop source table and tasks; cover or omit the facilitator section until students choose. Provide the rubric in advance; arrange private submission and accessible alternatives. A timer and shared display are optional. Do not ask students to put personal information in the fictional exercise.

Practice objectives: distinguish a source from an interpretation; write a question about recent behavior; use counterevidence to explain a choice; connect an audience, channel, truthful asset and useful action; revise after feedback. These are teaching objectives, not measured learning gains.

Minutes	Instructor move	Student artifact
0-10 · Frame	0-2: state the problem. 2-7: students think alone, without AI/templates. 7-10: compare their own structures.	Original notes and self-named headings, worksheet A.
10-30 · Evidence	10-14: read four fictional sources. 14-20: separate observation/interpretation. 20-25: discuss Nora and alternatives. 25-30: draft a past-behavior question and choose a next move.	Worksheet B: sources, uncertainty, question and decision.
30-50 · Marketing test	30-34: choose an audience/useful action. 34-40: propose two channels with access unknown. 40-46: draft one asset manually. 46-50: plan a bounded test and measurement.	Worksheet C: two routes, asset and proposed test.
50-60 · Peer check	50-54: partner describes audience/next action without explanation. 54-57: swap. 57-59: revise. 59-60: exit reflection.	One observed misunderstanding/action, revision and remaining unknown.

Opening prompt: “A student built a campus study-partner app. Before you see anyone else’s plan, what would you need to find out, decide or do next? Write your own notes and organize them in a way you could use.” Do not supply the answer or ask for a positive conclusion.

Teaching built into the workflow

- **Experiential learning:** rehearse a decision here; use a permitted real action in the field assignment.
- **Generative, student-led thinking before AI:** preserve the original board before adding prompts or AI.
- **Scaffolded practice:** reveal questions and checks after students create their own structure.
- **Formative peer feedback:** observe comprehension and an attempted next action; revise.
- **Metacognition and reflection:** explain what changed, what did not and what remains uncertain.
- **Responsible AI and human judgment:** keep AI optional; students review claims and own decisions.

Facilitation: ask “Which source supports that?” and “What else could explain it?” Accept a defensible decision to investigate further, retain a direction or stop. Score reasoning, not agreement with the model answer. No posting, contacting real groups or generating fake evidence occurs in this class.

Access: allow typing, handwriting, dictation to a chosen scribe, oral explanation or an accessible plain-text copy. Offer extra processing time by reducing the number of comparison examples, not the reasoning criteria. A solo self-check can replace a peer when pairing is inaccessible; label it honestly. No grade depends on AI use, network size, customers or spending.

StudyLoop: what changes the next move?

Fictional case · no real participants or results

A student's starting idea is a campus app for finding study partners. Their starting assumption: **"Students struggle to find enough people to study with."** These four perspectives are invented teaching material, not a customer dataset, testimonial or proof of demand.

Source ID	Fictional material	Source type
studyloop-maya	"I don't need more people. I need to know who's actually showing up."	Fictional direct quote
studyloop-owen	Describes repeated last-minute messages to work out who will attend a study session.	Fictional paraphrased note
studyloop-priya	Describes an existing group that works well when attendance is clear.	Fictional paraphrased note
studyloop-nora	Already has a reliable study group and does not want another app.	Fictional counterexample; paraphrased note

Give students these tasks

1. Select a source. State what it says without adding a cause, frequency or market size.
2. Write one tentative interpretation and another possible explanation.
3. Explain how Nora changes the audience assumption, if at all.
4. Write one question about a recent actual situation that could distinguish the explanations.
5. Choose a next move and explain what could change your mind.

Facilitator reasoning example · reveal after students choose

Observation: Maya describes uncertainty about attendance; Owen describes coordination messages. Priya's group works when attendance is clear. Nora reports a working routine and no desire for another app.

Interpretation: coordination may matter more than finding more people for some existing groups. **Alternative:** a clearer agreement in the group's existing chat may be sufficient. These excerpts do not establish how common either situation is or whether a new tool would help.

One defensible decision: focus on existing groups with unreliable attendance and test a simple confirmation flow before building a discovery feed. Asking more groups, retaining the original idea while seeking missing evidence, or stopping can also be reasoned choices.

Proposed experiment, not run: invite five consenting groups with this problem to try confirmations for one week and compare each group's own attendance records with its previous routine. Observe use, missed confirmations and workarounds. No result, payment, improvement rate or completed recruitment is supplied. An uncontrolled small test cannot isolate a causal effect.

Past-behavior question: "Tell me about the last study session when attendance was uncertain. What happened, and how did your group handle it?" Follow with "What happened next?" rather than "Would you use our app?"

Fictional marketing continuation

Consider a campus-club organizer introduction and a relevant digital study-group space. Exact venue/link, rules and access are **unknown**; do not invent them. Select a primary and alternative route for investigation.

Sample organizer request: "I'm testing a simple way for existing study groups to confirm attendance. Does your group have this problem? If appropriate, may I show the idea?" This is a fictional draft to critique, not a message to send. The destination and useful action must be defined before any real outreach.

Discussion: What evidence justifies the audience? What permission is missing? What would a recipient actually do? What observation would lead you to repeat, revise or stop? All counts remain unknown.

Worksheet A · think first

Complete before seeing the structured worksheets or using AI

Name or private course code: _____ Date: _____

Prompt: A student built a campus study-partner app. What would you need to find out, decide or do next? Write one idea per note, then create your own headings or groups. Circle what you do not know. You may draw or use an accessible document instead.

My own first structure

Compare, without replacing your first thinking

Explain your structure to a partner, or read it back to yourself. What is already actionable? What is missing? Keep the original visible and add changes in a different place or label them “revision.” This is a learning record, not verification that you never used AI elsewhere.

Stop here until the instructor reveals the case and worksheet B. AI is optional later. No grade depends on using it.

Worksheet B · evidence to a decision

Use only the fictional StudyLoop sources in class

Keep source text, your interpretation and uncertainty separate. Preserve Nora’s disagreement. Do not add participants, quotes, outcomes or percentages.

Source ID	What the source actually says	My tentative interpretation
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

Counterexample: What does Nora’s account challenge? What remains possible?

Alternative explanation: What else could account for the same observations?

Question quality: Write one short question about a recent situation or workaround. Avoid pitching or asking what someone “would” do.

My next decision: change / retain / investigate / stop. Explain why, using source IDs and an uncertainty. A different choice from the instructor’s example is welcome when supported.

What would change my mind? Name an observation, not a desired answer.

Next action and review point: What would I try or find out next?

Worksheet C · a small marketing test

Fictional plan in class · no outreach or results

Audience and situation: _____

First useful action: _____

Evidence / assumption / unknown: _____

Route	Exact place/link to investigate	Fit, access/rules and effort
Primary: physical or digital	Unknown until researched: _____	_____
Alternative: physical or digital	Unknown until researched: _____	_____

One asset: community post / organizer email or DM / caption / flyer / demo script.

Write your own truthful hook, builder disclosure and first ask. Describe the destination; do not invent a working link. A later optional AI draft remains a draft.

One-week proposal: owner _____ next task _____ due _____

Time/resource limit and $0 fallback: _____

Observe: relevant reach → visits/starts → useful action → return/referral. Which action matters most? What source/date range would record it? Baseline/result: **unknown; not run**.

Peer or self check · before explaining your intention

Partner says who it is for and what they would try next. In class, walk a sketch or describe the fictional destination; this is rehearsal, not a live launch check. Record what was understood or attempted, not just praise.

Check mode: peer / self **Observed response:** _____

Revision I made and why: _____

Exit reflection: What changed in my thinking? What remains uncertain?

One-week assignment · build, reach, learn

Your app, two reachable routes, one small test

Use a working app/prototype and your own permitted observations. The objective is an explained decision, not a customer quota. **$0 means no new cash spending:** time, existing AI allowance, equipment, printing, travel and access still have limits. No purchase or public disclosure is required.

Submit privately: original notes/structure; audience/evidence/unknowns; one neutral question about recent behavior; two-channel plan; one reviewed asset; tasks/resource limits; source-and-date measurement log; and a 200-300-word reflection or equivalent 2-3-minute oral/accessible response. Use the field worksheet or your own structure with the same information. The instructor states the actual dates, private submission route and contact for alternatives before assigning this work.

Day	Student action	Evidence to retain
1	Think alone before templates/AI. Name the audience and useful action, what is known and what is assumed.	Original notes and a permitted source; “unknown” where needed.
2	Investigate specific physical/digital places; choose primary and alternative. Check rules, access and resource needs.	Exact place/link, observation/date, permission status and fallback.
3	Make one truthful channel-specific asset. Connect asset → destination → useful action. Have a peer or self-check try the path.	First version, observed comprehension/action and revision.
4-6	If allowed and feasible, perform a small manual test. Log tasks and observations. Stop if permission/access fails.	Actual action/date, source, counts or unknown; support/reminders.
7	Review the evidence and decide repeat, revise or stop.	Reflection citing sources, limits, changed/retained decision and next step.

Before outreach: truthful feature/claim, builder relationship disclosed, destination works, useful action clear, community/venue permission checked, participant choices respected, and a realistic plan for responding. No unsolicited repeated messages or automatic sending. Being a classmate, enrolled student or known contact is not permission for every use.

People and data: ask permission before taking notes. External AI processing and sharing an excerpt require separate choices for the actual material and audience. Keep personal/contact details out of submissions; do not upload customer/student notes to AI by default. Stop or use the alternative if the relevant permission is absent. Classroom work is not automatically First Ten product research.

AI, optional only after your own plan: use permitted non-sensitive context, ask for a bounded draft, inspect unsupported claims and note what you changed. Example prompt: “Using only my supplied audience, constraints and channel observations, suggest questions I should investigate. Do not invent URLs, permissions, quotes or results.” Use your existing allowance or stay manual; do not subscribe or spend to meet the assignment.

Equivalent accessible/private alternative: use StudyLoop, inspect a public source without contacting people, and rehearse an asset/destination with a consenting peer or alone. Label everything simulated, proposed or observed in rehearsal. Leave field outcomes unknown and reflect on what would need checking. If you lack an app, access, time, a network or permission, this route earns the same rubric opportunities. An unrun test reported honestly is preferable to invented evidence.

Reflection prompts: What did I predict? What did I observe? Which source or disagreement affected my decision? What came from me, a peer, an instructor or AI? What is still unknown? What will I repeat, revise or stop, and why? Include course reminders/help; activity required for a course is not voluntary product retention.

Field worksheet · plan before acting

Keep your original structure; use these checks for omissions

Project/course code _____ Mode: field / private alternative / mixed

Test start _____ end _____ (7 inclusive days) Review date _____

Audience, situation and useful action: _____

Source/date supporting it; assumptions and unknowns: _____

Check	Primary route	Alternative route
Physical/digital; exact place or URL	_____	_____
Relevant observation + source/date	_____	_____
Access/rules: unknown/requested/allowed/denied	_____	_____
Basis/date of permission check	_____	_____
Time, resources and fallback	_____	_____

One neutral question about a recent situation: _____

Chosen asset format and truthful support: _____

My hook + builder disclosure + first ask: _____

Destination and first useful action: _____

Peer/self check: what was understood/done? What did I revise?

Task	Owner / due date	Prerequisite / done means
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

Available time / existing resources / AI limit: _____

$0 fallback; what I will not do: _____

Primary outcome / baseline or unknown / target or unknown: _____

Measurement source and period: _____

Repeat if _____ Revise if _____ Stop if _____

Field worksheet · what actually happened?

Unknown is different from zero. Proposed is different from completed.

Mode: field / rehearsal / self-check / not run Channel/asset _____

Period from _____ to _____ Check/reminder/help received _____

Do not combine peer tests, classmates, outside participants and automated traffic. Use another table for another group, channel or period. No personal identifiers are needed.

Measure	Count or unknown	Unit / source / date / limitation
Relevant reach	_____	_____
Visits or starts	_____	_____
Useful action: _____	_____	_____
Return	_____	_____
Referral leading to observed action	_____	_____

A requested/agreed/completed action and its source: _____

Optional rate: numerator _____ denominator _____ period _____

Calculate only with known counts, a positive denominator and the same population, period and unit, with the numerator inside the denominator. Otherwise write “not comparable” or “not measured.” Views do not establish use; an invitation or share does not establish referral adoption. A tagged link does not collect analytics by itself.

Reflection · written, spoken or another accessible format

Starting assumption and decision: _____

Observation that mattered, including disagreement; source/date: _____

My interpretation and another possible explanation: _____

Repeat / revise / stop, and why: _____

What remains unknown? What would change my mind? _____

Next action, owner and date: _____

Contribution statement: my thinking / peer or instructor help / optional AI. Explain what was accepted, changed or rejected. Do not include private prompt material.

Assessment · reasoning and participant respect

Four criteria, 0-3 each · 12 points total

Use for the case, fieldwork or private alternative. A well-reasoned stop or honestly unrun test can earn full credit. Explain expectations in advance. No automated grading or authenticity score is supplied.

Criterion	3 · clear	2 · developing	1 · needs revision	0 · missing
Question quality	Specific recent behavior/workaround; neutral, useful follow-up	Mostly concrete; one leading or vague part	Mainly pitches, hypotheticals or general opinions	No question to review
Source vs interpretation	Traceable source/type/date; interpretation distinct; counterevidence and unknowns retained	Distinction mostly clear; one source or limit missing	Claims outrun source; disagreement lost	No usable distinction or source
Revision and decision	Explains changed/retained/stopped decision, feedback and next test; acknowledges alternative explanation	Reasoning present but next step or feedback link weak	Cosmetic change or unsupported conclusion	No decision/reflection
Participant respect and honest reporting	Appropriate permissions/data minimization; truthful asset; simulation, unknowns and help labeled	Practices sound with a stated gap to resolve before acting	Missing access/data check or unclear evidence status	No respect/reporting plan; fabricated material presented as real

Do not grade: customer/revenue totals, network, spending, AI use, polish, positive validation or agreement with the instructor. Respect alternative formats and nondisclosure. A failed test can show sound reasoning; a successful count can have weak evidence.

Feedback: one supported source/decision, one uncertainty, one next action the student can choose. Ask for an explanation before assuming misconduct. Correct fabricated data through established institutional processes; this worksheet cannot verify that an interview occurred.

Pedagogical rationale and limits

The owner's BUS131 "Fail Faster, Fail Smarter," Week 6 slides inform this sequence: own structure before AI (pp. 4-5), audience/places (6-8), two routes and measures (12-14), tasks/resources (16-17), peer walkthrough/revision/reflection (20-24). This is curriculum provenance, not an effectiveness study.

Patricia Greene's Four Approaches to Teaching an Entrepreneurship Method (Babson, February 14, 2024) discusses practice, design and reflection. It informs the lesson's rationale; it is not endorsement or evidence of First Ten's efficacy.

The EEF's Metacognition and Self-Regulated Learning (second edition, November 13, 2025) is school-level guidance on planning, monitoring and evaluation. Applying it here is a design inference; do not transfer school attainment effects to university entrepreneurs or this app. Sources checked October 18, 2026.

Optional product and status

First Ten is optional; signed-in work requires an account. This kit runs on paper or in a document. At the kit's source revision, teacher panels, shared submissions and the full $0 Marketing Lab remain planned. Check deployed features before class. Neither activity requires an app, AI or paid account.

Adapt locally. Classroom participation and fictional examples are not product research, adoption evidence or proof of learning gains.